



FUEL WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 7 AUGUST 2026 - 13 AUGUST 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Fuel-market pressure remained High this week. Crude benchmarks rose and jet fuel climbed sharply, while reported disruption centred on Iran's export constraints, fuel rationing in Orenburg Region after a refinery strike, and a claimed attack linked to Saudi energy infrastructure at Jubail. The immediate operational meaning is tighter cost pressure with a live risk of local supply interruption where refinery or export disruption persists.

FAST FACTS

BRENT CRUDE

88.86 USD/bbl

+7.7% 7d

ICE Brent front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 13 Aug 2026

WTI CRUDE

83.08 USD/bbl

+7.5% 7d

NYMEX WTI front-month (Yahoo Finance)

As of 13 Aug 2026

JET FUEL

3.814 USD/gal

+14.8% 7d

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type · EIA / FRED

As of 11 Aug 2026

JET FUEL PRICE TRAJECTORY

U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel (USD/gal)

Latest 11 Aug: **3.81** USD/gal



U.S. Gulf Coast kerosene-type jet fuel, 6 observations from 04 Aug to 11 Aug.

Jet fuel latest available 11 Aug 2026 (daily EIA U.S. Gulf Coast series, publication trails the crude close); Brent and WTI run to 13 Aug 2026 (the period end).

MARKET READ

Brent crude is rising; WTI crude is rising; Jet fuel is rising.

SITUATION

The current backdrop is a rising crude complex, with Brent at 88.86 USD/bbl and WTI at 83.08 USD/bbl, while jet fuel rose to 3.814 USD/gal. Within that firmer price environment, this window also showed refinery-disruption, shortage and unrest rather than a broad, system-wide supply failure. Evidence confidence is moderate, so the direction of pressure is clear even where reporting on downstream effects remains incomplete.

WHAT HAPPENED

In Iran, reports said a US naval blockade squeezed oil exports, forced crude onto floating storage, stalled exports and left Kharg Island idle. In Russia, Orenburg Region imposed fuel rationing after a Ukrainian refinery strike, and separate reporting cited a fire at a major oil refinery in the Russian Far East amid a wider national fuel crisis. In Saudi Arabia, Houthis claimed an attack on a Saudi Aramco refinery and reports emerged of a blast at a gas facility in Jubail. Separate reporting from India focused on whether new refineries would help address fuel shortages in Central Asia, reinforcing that shortage concerns remain part of the regional market backdrop.

OPERATIONAL READ

Operational Read: 7 qualifying incidents across 5 distinct days. Iran is the primary pressure point. Overall severity: High.

REGIONAL HIGHLIGHTS

Regional Highlights: Iran is the primary pressure point; secondary pressure points are Russia, Saudi Arabia and Ukraine. Overall severity: High.

MARKET AND OPERATOR RESPONSES

ACTOR	CATEGORY	ACTION	OPERATIONAL READ
Saudi Aramco	Producer action	Houthi claim Saudi Aramco refinery attack; reports emerge of blast at Jubail gas facility 9 Aug 2026	Refinery-side change to regional product supply; watch crack spreads and downstream product availability.
OPEC	Producer action	IEA and OPEC split on global oil demand estimates as Strait of Hormuz closure drags 12 Aug 2026	Supply-side move with read-through to bunker, jet and downstream pricing if the action sustains.
ADNOC	Producer action	UAE condemns Iranian missile attack on Adnoc tanker 10 Aug 2026	Supply-side move with read-through to bunker, jet and downstream pricing if the action sustains.
Government / policy	Government / policy action	Russia's Orenburg region brings in fuel rationing after Ukrainian refinery strike, governor says 12 Aug 2026	Refinery-side change to regional product supply; watch crack spreads and downstream product availability.

WHAT MATTERS

The clearest continuity risk sits around physical supply and distribution rather than price alone. Fuel rationing in Orenburg Region points to immediate limits on local availability and can disrupt road movement, onward distribution and routine resupply schedules. Reported export disruption around Iran matters because sustained constraints at Kharg Island would keep pressure on regional flows and pricing. The Saudi incident matters because any confirmed impact on refining or gas infrastructure at Jubail would raise the risk of short-notice restrictions around industrial areas and transport corridors tied to the facility. The sharp rise in jet fuel is the most direct cost signal for aviation-linked travel and logistics even where no airport-specific shortage was reported this week.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Update fuel cost assumptions to reflect higher Brent, WTI and jet fuel prices.
- Check road-fuel availability and delivery schedules linked to Orenburg Region.
- Review contingency supply options for routes or sites exposed to Russian refinery disruption.
- Verify travel and access conditions around Jubail before non-essential movements.
- Reconfirm buffer stocks where operations rely on regular diesel or petrol deliveries.
- Refresh internal notices on possible short-notice fuel availability changes in affected areas.

WATCH NEXT

- Any extension or tightening of fuel rationing in Orenburg Region
- Further reports of disruption at the Russian Far East refinery after the fire
- Confirmation of operational impact at Jubail gas or refining facilities
- Any change in the status of Kharg Island operations
- Additional evidence that Iran's export constraints are easing or worsening
- Further movement in jet fuel after this week's sharp rise

POLESTAR VIEW

Risk level is High. The most likely disruption in the near term is localised fuel continuity pressure tied to refinery outages, rationing and export constraints, with the clearest current hotspots in Iran, Orenburg Region and Jubail. Prioritise fuel availability checks, route and access validation near affected energy sites, and cost-control adjustments for a rising market.

DISCLAIMER

Polestar Advisory Pte. Ltd. is an independent company registered in Singapore. The information in this report is based on open sources and is assessed as accurate at the time of writing. It is provided for general informational purposes only and does not constitute advice or a comprehensive assessment of all risks. No reliance should be placed on this information for operational decision-making without further independent verification.